



Old look in the new browser

regedit. Navigate to HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Software\Microsoft\Internet Explorer\Toolbar\WebBrowser and click on it to view the contents on the pane. Right click on the WebBrowser item and use Select > New > DWORD. Name the DWORD ITBar7Position and hit [Enter]. Double click on the new value and assign a value of 00000001. Make it a hexadecimal value. Close the editor, and restart IE 7 to see this view when you enable the menu bar.

Printing

When you need to print a Web page and you have to adjust the settings for headers, footers and margins, click on File > Page Setup. Click on Page Setup with the [Alt] key pressed. In the pop up, type in your measurements for the page setup, which are in inches. For changing them to millimetres, go to Control Panel > Region and Language Options. You can also change the size settings to A3, A4 and A5 and also choose between

Window title	&w
URL	&u
Date in short format (as specified by Regional and Language Options)	&d
Date in long format (as specified by Regional and Language Options)	&D
Time (as specified by Regional and Language Options)	&t
Time in 24-hour format	&T
Current page number	&p
Total number of pages	&P
Right-aligned text (following &b)	&b
Centred text (between &b&b)	&b&b
A single ampersand (&)	&&

Portrait and Landscape options. In the Header and Footer section, there are some operators such as &w, &b and &p. A complete list of the variable is given above. These variables can be also combined in the header and footer fields. Finally, use File > Print Preview to view the changes.

Add-ons For IE

In our past articles we have talked about add-ons for IE 7. Here, we are going to touch on a few nifty ones:

IE7 Open Last Closed Tab: This is a common problem for users of IE 7 who savour the Tabbed windows. Clicking on the X and all your open tabs close. This add-on will come in handy for such accidents. It creates a shortcut

[Ctrl] + [X] that lets you undo the closed tab. This is a free extension and can be downloaded from <http://tinyurl.com/3yzhlv>

Inline Search: This add-on mimics the find as you type functionality of Firefox.



Now mimic Firefox's [Ctrl] + [F]

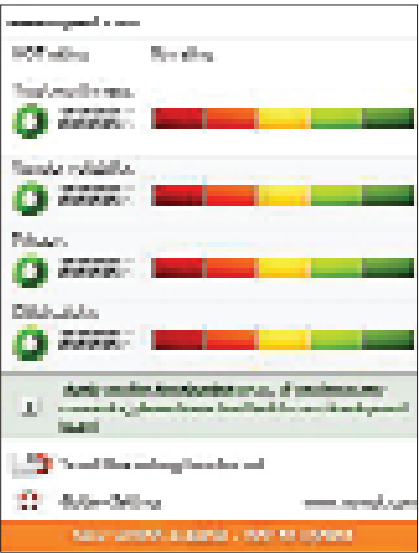
Press [Ctrl] + [F], and a toolbar will appear at the bottom of the browser window. All the instances of your search string are highlighted in the window. There are still some important shortcuts to remember: Esc closes the search pane, [F3] or [Enter] takes you to the next occurrence while [Shift] + [F3] or [Shift] + [Enter] will take you back. This add-on is free. Get it from www.ieforge.com/InlineSearch/HomePage

GooglePreviewIE: This add on is a boon for product and image searches. Also present in Firefox, this toolbar shows image previews of Web pages when you run a Google search. This is not an official Google offering like Google Toolbar. Get it from <http://ackroyd.de/googlepreview/>



View image previews of search results with GooglePreviewIE

Trust) is such an extension that constantly checks any Website you open, against a community submitted list and displays its appropriate ratings. This is based on a colour code, with green being highly reputed and red being potentially dangerous. After installing this add-on from



The different colour codes in WOT

<http://www.mywot.com/en/download/ie>, check the top right corner of your browser window. Monitor the colour of the ring as you keep browsing. In case you come across a Website that you suspect is harmful you can also submit the link for potential inclusion into the list of malicious sites.

IE's Compatibility Issues

IE 7 has started to adopt Web standards for rendering HTML elements, in contrast to the previous versions that had a plethora of standard-related issues. However, due to an almost 90 per cent share of the browser market, most Web developers had to hack their source code in "illegal" ways so that their rendering would not be broken. Many sites you will visit on the WWW have still not updated their code, and will be rendered horribly, with fonts and links askew. A registry hack can allow you to display such sites in IE7 with IE6's default behavior.

Go to Start > Run, type regedit and press [Enter]. Go to HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Internet Settings\5.0\User Agent. Right-click on the white space and select New > String Value. Name the string Version. Right-click on the new value and select Modify. Insert MSIE 6.0, close the registry editor and restart IE. All sites will now be rendered properly.

Speed Up IE

Like Firefox, IE is very slow to load pages. There are various reasons for this: the number of simultaneous connections that IE makes with the server is limited and it also keeps searching for network shares and printers. There are some registry tweaks to get around this problem and

significantly improve your Internet browsing experience.

In the Registry editor, go to HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Explorer\RemoteComputer\NameSpace/{D6277990-4C6A-11CF-8D87-00AA0060F5BF} and delete the key named Printers. That ought to do the trick.

For opening up to 16 simultaneous connections with the remote server, and hence pushing your speeds up considerably, you need to modify (or create, if they don't exist) two values in the registry. Go to HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Internet Settings and check these two DWORD values: MaxConnectionPer1_0Server and MaxConnectionsPerServer. Change their values to 0000010 and 00000010 respectively. After doing the customary restart you will notice increase in browsing speeds.

Normalizing The Size Of A New Window

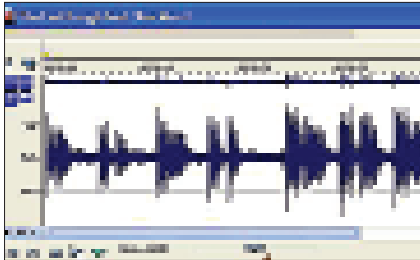
IE 7 has this annoying behaviour where clicking on a link in sites causes another window to open in the middle of the screen. Most people maximise this window by clicking on the Maximize button. However, the next time you open a link the same behaviour is repeated.

There is a simple tweak to get rid of this behaviour. Whenever you open a new link in a new window stretch the window so that it covers 100 per cent of the desktop. Restart IE again and click on the links. You should see the new window open full size.

SOUNDFORGE

Soundforge, a proprietary audio editing package by Sony, is used by professionals as well as amateurs to insert audio effects to sound tracks, repair damaged tracks, master and mix them and perform encoding tasks.

Costing between US\$299.95 to US\$319.95 (approximately Rs. 12000 to Rs. 12800), depending on the packaging

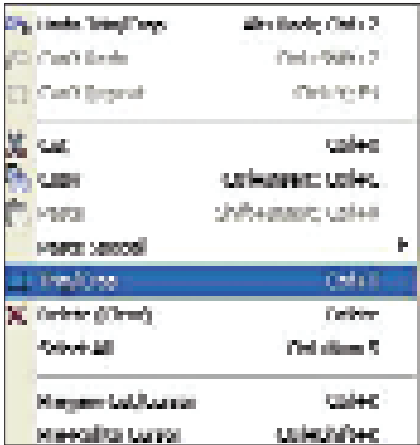


Soundforge graphically displays music

offered, they also offer a 30 day free trial—get it on this month's DVD. Whenever you open a file in Soundforge, the track is displayed in a series of waves and troughs, resembling seismograms. From the graph, you could figure out regions with either a high pitch or, say, low bass.

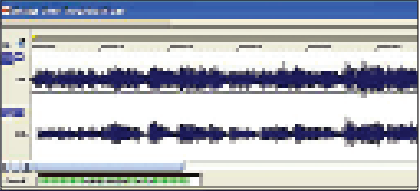
Effects

You enjoy a particular soundtrack, but don't want to hear the applause at the start and end of the track? Just open the track from the Open menu and hit the play button. Once you encounter the regions in the soundtrack where the clapping and whooping takes place, use the cursor to select them and hit the delete button. On the other hand, if you want to retain only a particular part of the file, and cut the rest out, go to Edit > Trim/Crop.

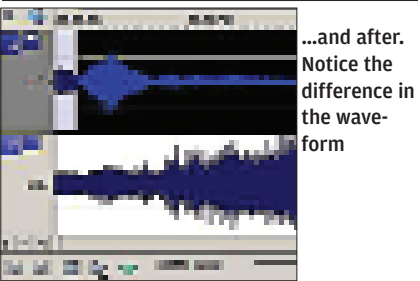


Options in the edit menu

The Effects menu has additional options to manipulate files. All these effects, when used sensibly and combined together, can mean the difference between a professionally edited track and an amateur recording. Each option has several sub options,



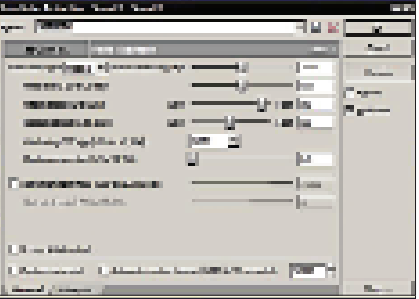
This was the waveform before the envelope was applied



and detailing them would exceed the available space. Take, for instance, the Envelope option (Effects > Envelope). Envelope is a tool used to make the soft parts sound louder and lower the volume of the louder parts. You can adjust the volume depending on some preset parameters. It is used when you need to give different types of "fade" effects. You have custom effects provided, however by using the graph you can create your own effects. The waveform changes when the envelope effect is applied as you can see from the screenshots here.

Hush

Many audio tracks, which would otherwise sound awesome, remain unheard and unappreciated because of an unfortunate problem during recording. Now with noise reduction tools available, you don't need to bury your recordings of that baby talk because of honking in the background. Use the noise reduction tool from Tools > Noise Reduction to get rid of all external noise. There are options such as Noise bias, Attack speed and Windowing overlap. All these options reduce the external noise. The best way to edit, for newbies, at least, is by trial and error—tweak around the

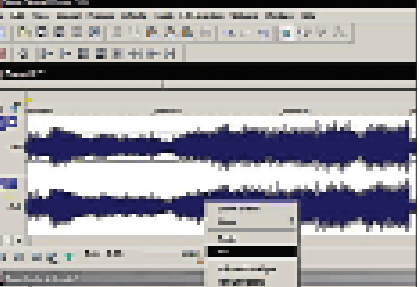


This tool provides options for removing external noise

sliders and preview the effect each time. When you are satisfied with the output, hit the OK button.

Mix And Match

What's the difference between DJs and us? They mix music, we don't. Mixing audio tracks may sound a bit



Mixing two or more tracks in Soundforge